



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chapel Field Christian School
School Website: <https://www.chapelfield.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chapel Field Christian Schools (Chapel Field) presents a coherent classical Christian orientation across all six rubric categories. The school's public materials frequently foreground the transcendental aims of truth, goodness, and beauty; a Christ-centered, theology-infused framework; formation of character; and a curriculum and pedagogy steeped in classical tradition (great books, commonplaces, and historical breadth). The school explicitly states its mission to partner with parents, to cultivate virtue and wisdom, and to engage students in a culture of learning described in terms such as "Scholé" (restful study) and "great books." These elements align strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators for Classical education and show little evidence of the Negative Keyword signals that would indicate secularization or a departure from classical aims.

- Core public statements signaling the religious/metaphysical foundations: Christ-centered culture; truth, goodness, beauty; the transcendentals; theology and sacred tradition.
- Explicit articulation of forming virtue and wisdom rather than merely preparing for college/work.
- Curriculum signals aligning with classical emphasis: Great Books/Great Books reading; grammar, elective focus on classical storytelling; commonplace books; direct statements about classical, Christian, Western tradition.
- Pedagogy signals: emphasis on contemplation, "Scholé," and a language of reading, discussing, and debating great ideas; in practice, a community-oriented, worshipful culture with a focus on formation.
- Faculty as a living curriculum and strong leadership/administration presence; explicit parent partnership and parent education signals.
- Active parent partnership with opportunities for engagement, tours, and open access to campus.

Overall classification (aggregate): CLASSICAL

What would move the needle: Not applicable here, as all six categories align with Classical indicators. No major shifts are required to reach a fully Classical rating.

Abstract-level takeaway: Chapel Field presents a clearly Classical Christian program across religious foundations, purpose and goal, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty identity, and parent/community engagement, anchored in Christ-centered formation, virtue, and wisdom, with explicit Great Books-driven sensibilities and community formation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a Christ-centered educational culture and the "three transcendentals" of truth, goodness, and beauty as soil for growth. This is stated as a core curricular assumption: "the entire educational experience in a Christ-centered culture" with "truth incarnate" and the soil of "truth, goodness, and beauty." - The mission explicitly anchors formation in Christian/theological terms: "partner with parents to cultivate a joyful community of students who love the truth, pursue wisdom and virtue, and live for the glory

of the Lord Jesus Christ.” - The school frames its academic philosophy as grounded in Classical, Christian, and Western tradition and emphasizes sacred tradition and the Logos.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits (from the school’s materials): truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, moral imagination, sacred tradition, theology, liturgy (implicit), Christ-centered, Logos. - Negative hits: none detected in the public materials; no secular, relativistic, or value-neutral language is evident in the retrieved statements. The Classical keyword lexicon’s negative signals (e.g., secularism, relativism) do not appear in the Chapel Field materials.

Why this rating - The materials consistently anchor education in transcendentals, theology, and liturgical/-community life, and they situate learning within a sacred-tradition framework. The explicit Christ-centered framing and the commitment to truth, goodness, and beauty strongly match the Positive Keyword indicators for RELIGIOUS and METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS in the classical rubric.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation over mere information and emphasize cultivating virtue and wisdom rather than job preparation: “not merely to produce transcripts ... nor is it merely to prepare them to get good jobs... Rather, our aim is to prepare them to become men and women of virtue, equipped with the tools for learning.” - The mission centers on cultivating souls and developing character with a teleological aim toward wisdom, virtue, and truth (the transcendental triad). - The school explicitly connects education to the Western/traditional canon and to a desire for students to become lifelong learners and virtuous individuals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits: formation, cultivation of virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, liberal education, telos.

- Negative hits: none present in public-facing materials (no emphasis on workforce-preparation or college-workforce metrics as the primary aim). The classical lexicon’s negative terms (e.g., “career-ready” emphasis) do not appear on the site.

Why this rating - The school’s stated goals center on virtuous formation and the pursuit of truth, rather than a narrow job-readiness or utilitarian curriculum. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL as per the positive indicators.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The language explicitly signals a classical curricular posture: emphasis on Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric, and engagement with great stories and primary sources (e.g., “great stories, fables, fairy tales ... the Bible” in the grammar school; “great books” and a commonplace book in high school). - The school references studying and reading Great Books and engaging in a grammar/logic/rhetoric framework, as well as celebrating and studying Western tradition and “the great authors.” The CORE VALUES page also frames a tradition of studying great authors and thinkers. - There is explicit mention of a curriculum anchored in the classical canon (classical, Christian, Western tradition) and a pedagogical approach that honors historical texts and the tradition of learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits: great books, great stories, Bible, commonplace book, grammar, logic, rhetoric, study of Western tradition, traditional canon. - Negative hits: none detected in public-facing materials (no replacement with modern social studies framing or STEM-first framing). The classical lexicon’s negative terms are not present in the site’s curriculum language.

Why this rating - The site demonstrates a curriculum that explicitly embraces classical elements (grammar/-logic/rhetoric, Great Books, foundational texts, tempering with sacred tradition). The presence of “grammar school ... great stories ... Bible” and “great books ... commonplace book” strongly supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical language emphasizes “Scholé” (restful learning) and engaging in contemplation, as well as dialogic and Socratic-style inquiry in higher grades. The CORE VALUES page explicitly states: “we read, study, contemplate, and debate great ideas together ... Scholé, the Latin word from which we derive our English word for school.” It also signals a culture of singing and conversation as a feature of the school.

- The content also references the practice of commonplaces and the cultivation of wisdom through reading, discussion, and the study of great texts. The “Treasure Hunt” piece explicitly discusses finding wisdom in great books, teachers, hymns, sermons, and more. This aligns with a formative, dialogic pedagogy rather than a purely skills-based model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits: Scholé, contemplation, wonder, debate/seminars, rhetoric, memory work, narration, great books, commonplaces, teacher as mentor, living books.

- Negative hits: none apparent in public-facing materials (the site emphasizes restful and dialogic approaches rather than pure project-based or constructivist-only models). The negative signals in the lexicon are not present in the site materials.

Why this rating - The pedagogy signals—Scholé, contemplation, memory, discussion of great ideas, and a clear emphasis on classical dialogic practices—are consistent with CLASSICAL pedagogy, rather than a purely project-based or constructivist approach.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site presents a faculty culture framed as mentors and guides with a living curriculum approach, and it highlights individuals in leadership roles (e.g., Academic Dean, Head of Schools) who embody the school’s mission and values. The explicit focus on staff, faculty, and administration as part of the school’s public identity is visible. The “Portrait of a Graduate” and references to faculty-staff indicate a teacher-led, virtue-formation-oriented model. - The presence of named faculty (e.g., Academic Dean, teachers) and a stated mission that the faculty embodies “the living curriculum” aligns with the classical model described in the knowledge base as a faculty that models virtue and acts as mentors. - Public materials also emphasize core values that describe teachers and staff as rooted in a classical tradition, and the school provides a public portrait of what a teacher should be and what a student should be (per the classical model).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, portrait of a teacher, teachers as exemplars, faculty as core to the school, professional development in classical pedagogy. - Negative hits: none detected in the public-facing materials (no significant emphasis on non-classical staff structures). Classical lexicon negative signals are not present in the school’s faculty language.

Why this rating - The public materials present a faculty culture that aligns with a Classical vision of teachers as virtuous models and mentors forming the core of the school’s curriculum and ethos, consistent with the “living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” notions.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school repeatedly emphasizes partnership with parents as co-educators and as primary partners in forming a classical education: “partner with parents to cultivate a joyful community of students who love the truth, pursue wisdom and virtue...” and similar language about parent involvement and formation. - There are explicit signals about parent formation (parents reading, attending gatherings, book studies) and an open campus with opportunities for visits, tours, and involvement in the school community. - The school’s core values and communications highlight family engagement, catechesis at home, and a shared mission with parents/ families as co-educators.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits: partnership with families, parent formation, parent education (book studies, gatherings), open campus, parent involvement, home-school collaboration, family catechesis.

- Negative hits: none detected in public materials. Negative signals such as consumerism or minimal parent involvement are not evident in the site’s text.

Why this rating - Chapel Field presents a robust model of parent engagement and family partnership that is central to classical education as described in the knowledge base. The site consistently frames parents as co-educators and signals opportunities for parent formation and campus involvement, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- All six categories independently align with Classical indicators, with explicit evidence across the site (Christ-centered formation, virtuous aims, Great Books/grammar-logic-rhetoric orientation, Scholé pedagogy, living-curriculum faculty, and strong parent-community partnership). The school's own materials strongly echo the Positive Keyword indicators and show minimal to no Negative Keyword signals.

What would move the needle

- Not applicable given CLASSICAL aggregate rating. No major needle-moving changes are required to reach or maintain CLASSICAL status.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.